



Some of Taher's favourites

Favourite Movie: *Sholay*

Favourite Actor: Amitabh Bachchan

Favourite Actress: Hema Malini

Favourite Food: *Dal chawal*

Favourite Drink: Diet Coke

Favourite Travel Destination: The Galápagos Islands

Favourite Book: *Homo Sapiens*

Favourite Sport: Cricket

Real-Life Role Model/Inspiration: Mother

Favourite Quote: Wake up every morning and do your best. Everyone—whether it is a human, an animal, or even the tiniest bacteria—gets 24 hours in a day. The key to a fruitful life is making the most of those 24 hours, every single day.

A leader without a company

In 2018, after years of hard work and leadership, circumstances forced Taher to sell Open-Silicon. The company's investor, a private equity firm, needed the cash, and Taher had no choice but to let go of the company he and his friends had built. It was another setback. But by then, Taher had learned one of the most valuable lessons of all—failure is never the end.

"I did not want to sell. It was heartbreaking. I had to let go of something I had built from the ground up," he recalls. After dedicating 15 years to Open-Silicon, he left a successful startup that had grown into an industry disruptor. But now, for the first time in years, he was not leading a company.

Money had stopped being a concern long back for Taher. Still, the urge to make a mark was strong, so he teamed with another entrepreneur to build an ASIC business at Invecas Corp. Unfortunately, Covid disrupted those plans also, and Taher went back to where it all started—Intel.

Returning to Intel in 2020, Taher took on the role of Vice President and General Manager in the Graphics Processing Unit (GPU) division. His mission? To take on Nvidia by

creating custom silicon solutions with the Graphics IP that Intel owns and establish Intel as a leader in the graphics industry. It was a high-stakes challenge. Nvidia had long dominated the GPU market, and catching up would require a combination of innovation, strategy, and execution.

"We believed that we could change the industry. Intel originally started its graphics division years ago during my first tenure at Intel. I knew the team, I knew the technology,

and I truly believed we could beat Nvidia," he shares.

However, the reality of corporate decision-making often clashes with vision. Despite efforts to build a competitive GPU business, the challenges were immense. Intel struggled to fund the custom silicon business, and in 2022, the company decided to shut down that part of the graphics division. It was another setback, another failure. "My first failure at Intel was when I switched from Processor to Communications division in the late 1990s. The second was when I took on the responsibility of proliferating the Graphics Xe architecture through custom silicon," he reflects.

But if there was one thing Taher had learned from his journey, it was that failure is never the end.

The quest for something new

At this point, Taher had seen it all—success, failure, entrepreneurship, corporate leadership, and even the pain of losing a company he built. He had reached a stage where he could have retired comfortably. But that was never his style. It was then that Quest Global produced an opportunity.

The CEO and CBO of Quest

Global shared a vision with Taher to create a generational company and take Quest Global public someday.

That one sentence reignited something in Taher. "I had always wanted to take Open-Silicon public, but circumstances had prevented it. Now, here was another chance to do it, one more time," he narrates.

After careful consideration, he agreed to take on the challenge. He joined Quest Global, in its semiconductor division, with the goal of assisting the company toward an IPO. News reports have been rife with probable dates and figures for an IPO valuation, but Taher remains unfazed by any report with a calm, stoic smile that perseveres through decades of struggle and turmoil.

Looking back at his career, Taher acknowledges that the road has not always been smooth. Carrying the pride of massive successes and the despair of bitter failures, he advises, "Ambition alone is not enough. You can have a vision, but if you do not execute it flawlessly, you will not reach your goal."

He also believes that true leadership is about working at the next level before you get there. "If you want to grow, you have to start acting like the person you aspire to be. Do not wait for a title to start behaving like a leader," he says.

After all these years, his biggest motivation remains the same—helping others grow. "For a long time, I have taught maths and science to underprivileged kids. At this stage of my life, if I can impact someone's life the way my mentors impacted mine, then I would have done something meaningful," he says.

As for what he wants to be remembered for? His answer is simple: "If just one person says, 'If it were not for Taher, I would not be here,' then I know I have done my job." **EFY**